

Nobuyoshi Shimmen

Engineer

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About Me

Full-stack engineer and PdM with 10+ years of experience building products from zero in startups. I take ownership across the entire product lifecycle — from customer discovery and planning to engineering and support — while keeping business impact as the primary compass. Over the past year I've leaned heavily on LLMs for code generation and Dev/Ops automation, shipping and operating a product as the sole engineer. I thrive at the intersection of business and engineering, and I've seen firsthand why good initial design matters when a product scales.

Experience

PLAID, Inc. /PdM/Engineer

DEC 2025 - PRESENT, TOKYO

- Transitioned to PLAID, Inc. following the merger, continuing to drive product growth as a dual PdM and Engineer.
- Led the Proof of Concept (PoC) for same-day data acquisition; collaborated with PMM and a client to upgrade data freshness from a T-1 (previous day) to a same-day basis.
- Spearheaded AI enablement initiatives by organizing Claude (Cowork) study sessions for ad operations teams, facilitating the practical application of GenAI in daily workflows.
- Delivered a comprehensive data solution for a major retail client, designing data marts in BigQuery and building visualization dashboards in Looker Studio.

agito, Inc. /PdM/Tech Lead

SEPT 2018 - NOV 2025, TOKYO

2024/10 - 2025/11

- Led the end-to-end development of a new product line as the sole engineer, owning planning, development, and support independently. Collaborated with the sales team for enterprise client discovery. Leveraged LLMs for code generation and Dev/Ops automation to ship and operate the product single-handedly.
- Developed an AI-driven creative generation tool that automatically produces ad banners and copy from landing page content using Gemini API and OpenAI API.
- Built an ad campaign search engine by implementing vector search on BigQuery and Vertex AI, enabling semantic queries beyond the capabilities of the existing keyword-based system.
- Engineered an ad performance simulation tool that leverages historical performance data to predict results for new campaigns, to generate forecasts for new campaigns.

2023/01 - 2024/09

- As Tech Lead, drove the core system modernization, strategically adopting serverless technology to enable same-day data retrieval as a key business differentiator.
- As PdM, led a cross-functional development team of 8-10 engineers while closely collaborating with the CS team (5-6 members) to streamline feedback loops and product delivery.
- Defined and managed product roadmap in collaboration with CEO and PMM to align business strategy with technical execution.
- Bridged the gap between business and engineering by translating business requirements into technical specifications and prioritizing development tasks.
- Acted as a technical representative in high-touch customer onboarding sessions to facilitate complex integrations for enterprise clients.
- Improved user experience by building an instant reporting flow with Looker Studio via Linking API integration.
- Developed rapid prototypes for beta features (e.g., GA4, AppsFlyer, and Adjust integrations) using Google Apps Script, enabling quick validation of market needs with minimal dev resources.

2018/09 - 2022/12 — Joined the PLAID Group in 2022/10

- Led a team of 3-5 programmers and diligently managed progress on top of reviewing performance.
- Acted as representative of engineers and led communication to the business team.
- Developed original ad data collecting applications from the ground up in collaboration with the company's CTO.
- By helping work through product scalability issues, connected ad accounts grew from 3,000 to 20,000 (number of ad reports acquired: approx).

200,000/day).

- Migrated existing ad data collecting applications to serverless infrastructure.
- Responsible for the operation of ad data collecting applications and developing new features.
- Built a prototype program to determine the industry from the ad text
- Developed an application to create data marts to link ad data with customer data.
- Developed an application to generate SQL for BI tools.
- Developed an application to generate Excel reports.
- Developed a web application as a full-stack developer.

ubun,inc. / Freelance Engineer

FEB 2021 - APR 2022, TOKYO

- Developed an application targeted for Amazon sellers.
- Responsible for front-end, back-end, and batch processing as a full stack developer.

TVISION Insights Inc. / Freelance Engineer

JUN 2018 - AUG 2018, TOKYO

- Created an internal web application.
- Resourcefully and confidently managed time and projects independently.

Techloco, Inc. / Engineer

OCT 2015 - JUL 2018, TOKYO

- Collaborated in developing an all-in-one marketing tool.
- Proposed and developed an application that allows users to review, comment on website designs on their browsers.

Soldout, Inc. / Marketing Division

APR 2014 - SEP 2015, TOKYO

- Developed Google Apps Scripts, using Salesforce API, and Hubspot API to improve business workflow.

Education

Aoyama University / Bachelor of Business Administration, BBA
APR 2010 - MAR 2014, TOKYO

The University of Vermont / Concentration in Business
AUG 2012 - MAY 2013, BURLINGTON, VERMONT, USA

- 9 month long exchange program through International Partnership & Collaboration

Skills & Interests

Computer Languages

Proficient Level: Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, PHP, HTML/CSS, SQL

Intermediate Level: Node.js

Hobby: Dart, Python, Swift

Infrastructures

GCP

Compute: Cloud Run, GAE, GCE

Data: BigQuery, Cloud SQL, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Storage

Messaging: PubSub, Cloud Scheduler

AI/ML: Vertex AI (Vector Search)

Observability: Cloud Monitoring, Cloud Logging, Cloud Build

Other: Firebase

AWS: EC2, S3

CI/CD & Tools: GitHub Actions, Circle CI, Docker, Git

Generative AI: Claude (Cowork/Code), OpenAI API, LLM Prompt Engineering

Languages

Native Level: Japanese

Business Level: English (TOEIC score 960)

Interests and Hobbies

- Developing entrepreneurial side projects
- Running an independent side service
- Spending time with family
- Studying fitness and working out

Certificates

Udacity/Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree

2016-2017

Udacity/iOS Engineer Nanodegree

2015

Links

Blog

<https://www.tumblr.com/blog/nobuyoshi-shimmen>

GitHub

<https://github.com/Generalbelly>

LinkedIn

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/nobuyoshi-shimmen-9a8b1a94/>
